

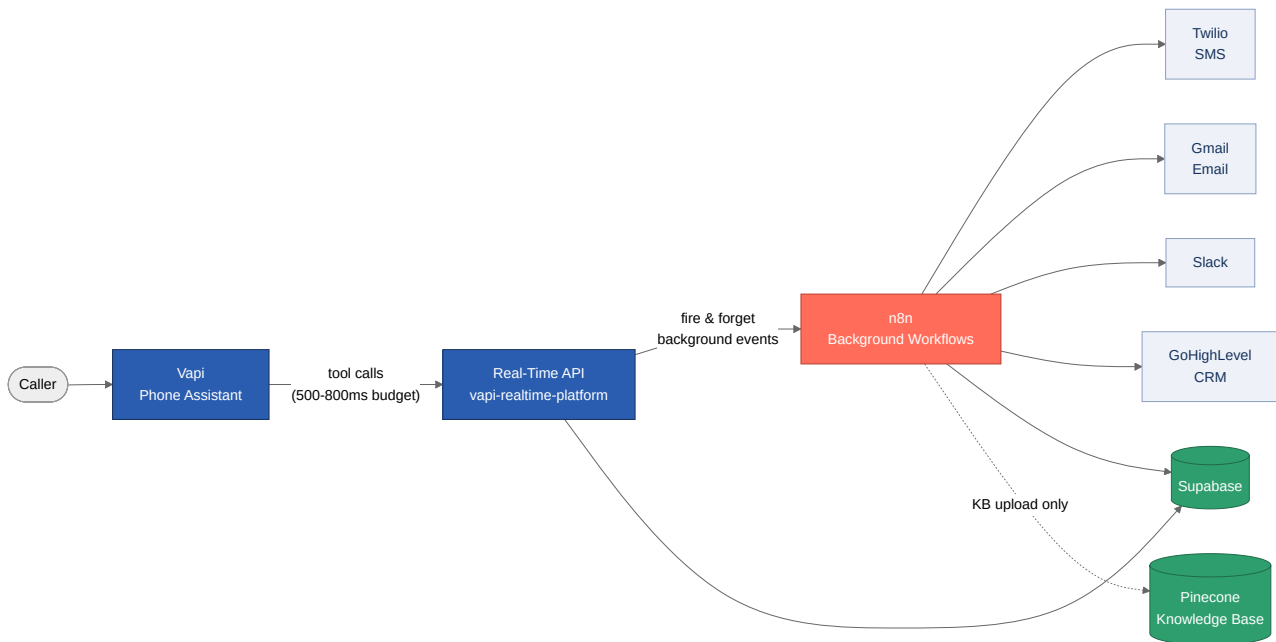
n8n Background Workflows

Setup Guide — plain language, with diagrams

July 2026

n8n Background Workflows — Setup Guide (plain-language)

This folder has **9 workflows**. They run *after* the phone call already happened — nothing here talks to the caller in real time. Import them into n8n in the order listed below.



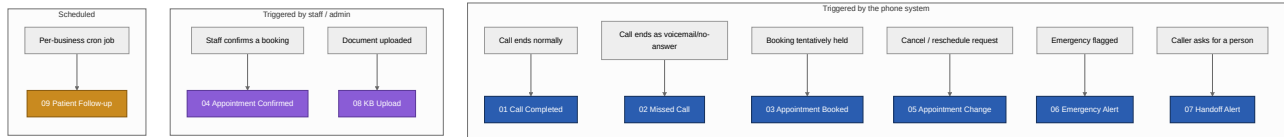
The phone system (Vapi) only ever talks to the real-time API. The API answers the caller immediately, then separately — without making the caller wait — tells n8n what happened. n8n is the only thing that talks to Twilio, Gmail, Slack, GHL, and (for knowledge uploads) Pinecone.

What changed from your original 5 files

- **Appointment Booked** no longer texts the customer "confirmed." Every phone booking is a *tentative hold* — the customer gets "we've received your request, our team will confirm shortly," and your staff get a Slack ping to review it.
- **New: Appointment Confirmed.** This is the workflow that sends the real "you're confirmed" text/email — but only when a staff member actually triggers it (see "How staff confirm a booking" below). This matches what you asked for: staff confirm, then the confirmation goes out.
- **New: Emergency Alert, Handoff Alert, Appointment Change (cancel/reschedule).** These three didn't exist before. They cover the AI phone system flagging an emergency, a caller asking for a real person, and a cancel/reschedule request — all of which previously had nowhere to notify your team.
- **Knowledge Base Upload** now has the same safety net as your other workflows: if something fails partway through, it gets logged and posted to `#automation-alerts` instead of failing silently.
- Every workflow that posts a note to GoHighLevel (GHL) now **checks first** whether it actually has a GHL contact/location ID. If it doesn't, it skips that one step instead of erroring out — nothing else in the workflow is affected.

- Field names in every workflow now match exactly what the phone-answering API (`vapi-realtime-platform`) sends. No manual re-mapping needed.

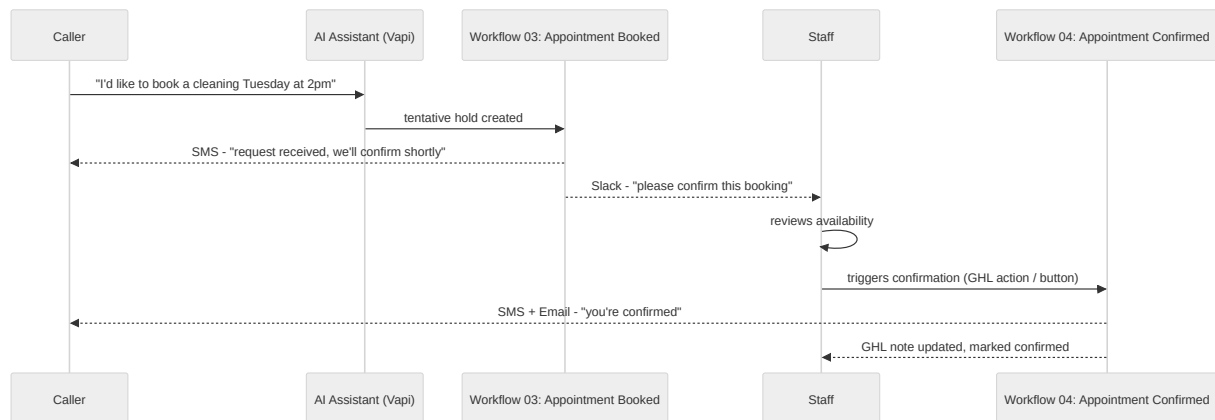
The 9 workflows, in import order



#	File	Fires when	What it does
1	01-call-completed.json	Every call ends (normal conversation)	Stores transcript, AI-summarizes the call, saves it, updates GHL, pings staff if it needs follow-up
2	02-missed-call.json	A call ends as voicemail/no-answer	Texts the caller back, emails/Slacks staff, creates a GHL callback task
3	03-appointment-booked.json	AI tentatively holds a time slot	Texts customer "request received," notes it in GHL, pings staff to confirm
4	04-appointment-confirmed.json	Staff confirm a booking	Sends the real "you're confirmed" text + email, updates GHL and your records
5	05-appointment-change.json	Caller cancels/reschedules	If it's straightforward: confirms the change. If it's last-minute or unclear: tells the customer staff will follow up, and pings staff urgently
6	06-emergency-alert.json	AI flags an emergency	Texts + emails your on-call number immediately, creates an urgent GHL task, Slacks the team
7	07-handoff-alert.json	Caller asks for a real person	Emails staff, creates a GHL callback task, Slacks the team
8	08-kb-upload.json	You upload/update a knowledge document	Splits it into chunks, creates embeddings, stores it in Pinecone, tells the phone API to stop using the old cached answers
9	09-patient-followup.json	Scheduled (per business)	Sends review-request texts a few days after a completed visit

Import 1–8 as regular workflows (each has its own webhook trigger). Workflow 9 is a bit different — see below.

How staff confirm a booking (workflow 4)

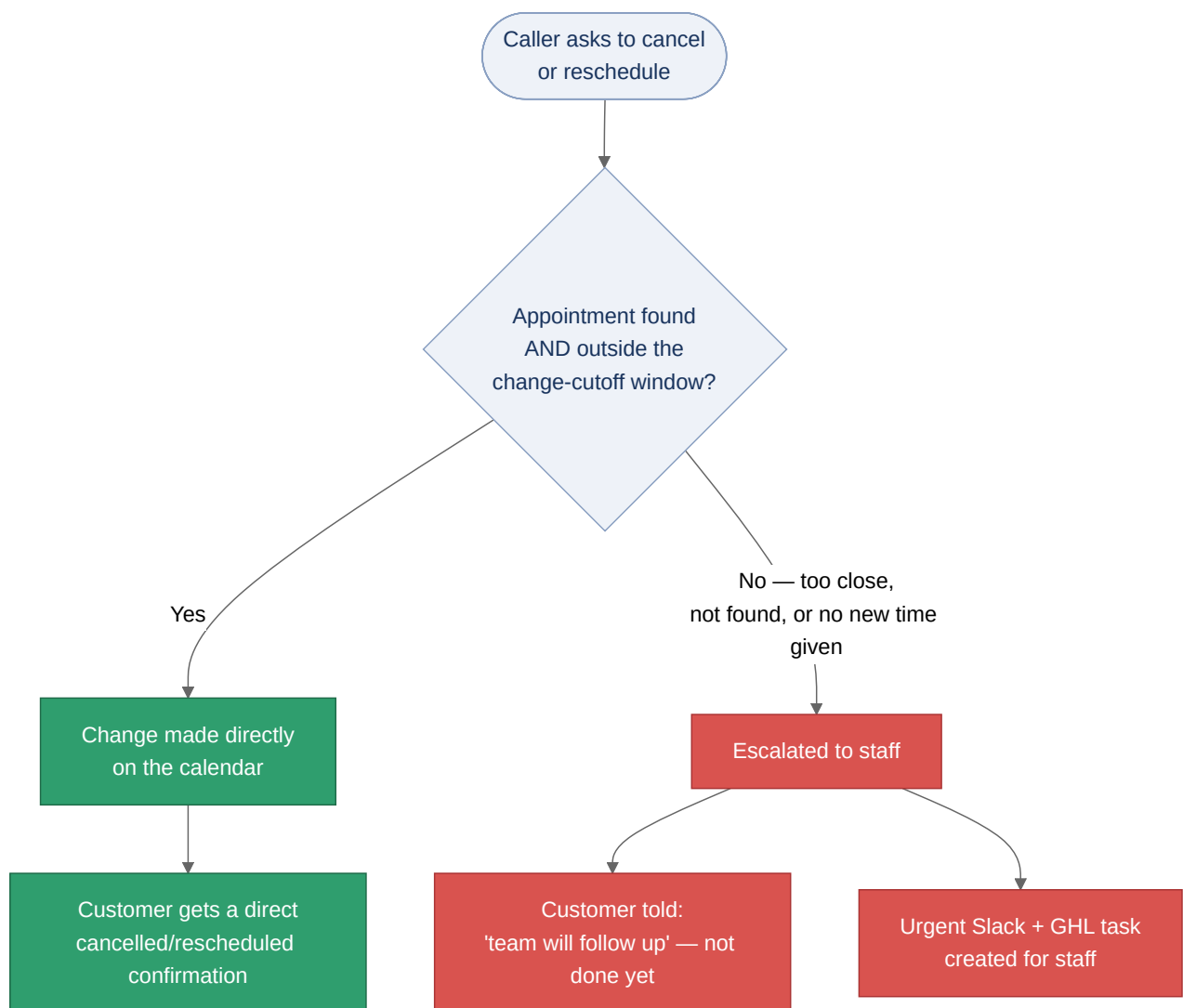


Workflow 4 needs *something* to call it once a staff member has actually checked and confirmed the appointment. Pick whichever is easiest for you — none of these require writing code:

- **Simplest:** a GoHighLevel automation that fires this webhook whenever an appointment's pipeline stage is moved to "Confirmed."
- **Also simple:** any basic web form or button (even a bookmarked link) your front desk clicks that sends the appointment's details to this webhook.

Whichever you pick, it needs to send the same information as workflow 3 (customer name/phone/email, appointment time, service, business name).

How cancel/reschedule decisions work (workflow 5)



The phone system only makes the change itself when it's confident and there's enough notice — otherwise it hands it to staff rather than guessing.

Credentials you'll need in n8n

Credential	Used by	Notes
Supabase	almost every workflow	same database as the rest of the project
Gmail	Call Completed, Missed Call, Appointment Confirmed, Emergency Alert, Handoff Alert	staff-facing emails
Twilio	Missed Call, Appointment Booked, Appointment Confirmed, Appointment Change, Emergency Alert, Patient Follow-up	customer-facing texts
Slack	every workflow	team notifications — see channel list below
Go High Level (GHL) API	Call Completed, Appointment Booked, Appointment Confirmed, Appointment Change, Missed Call, Emergency Alert, Handoff Alert	CRM notes/tasks (skipped gracefully if not configured for a business)
OpenAI	Call Completed (summarizing), KB Upload (embeddings)	
Pinecone	KB Upload	your knowledge base storage
Internal API Key (HTTP Header Auth)	KB Upload's "Flush Knowledge Cache" step	header name <code>x-internal-secret</code> , value must match the phone API's <code>INTERNAL_API_SHARED_SECRET</code> setting

Environment variables n8n needs

Set these in n8n's environment (Settings → Environment Variables, or your hosting platform's config):

- `TWILIO_FROM_NUMBER` — the number texts are sent from
- `FRONT_DESK_ALERT_EMAIL` — where staff email alerts go
- `FRONT_DESK_ALERT_PHONE` — where the Emergency Alert text goes (an on-call phone number)
- `REALTIME_API_BASE_URL` — the phone-answering API's base URL (used only by KB Upload's cache-flush step)

Default Slack channels (override anytime)

Every workflow accepts a `slackChannel` field from the caller; if it's blank, these defaults are used:

`#calls` , `#missed-calls` , `#bookings` (both booked and confirmed), `#appointment-changes` , `#emergencies` , `#handoffs` , `#kb-updates` , `#followups` . All error alerts always go to `#automation-alerts` regardless.

Supabase tables these workflows read/write

Most of these should already exist from your earlier builds. Double-check these are present before going live: `call_transcripts`, `calls`, `follow_up_tasks`, `appointments`, `customers`, `kb_document_versions`, `audit_log`, `workflow_execution_log`, `workflow_errors`. The phone-answering API also needs three new columns — already included in its own database setup (`ghl_contact_id` on customers, `ghl_location_id` / `front_desk_owner_id` / `slack_channel` on businesses) so it can pass GHL and Slack details through to these workflows.

A quick word on the "Has GHL Contact/Location?" checks

If a business hasn't been set up in GHL yet (or a specific caller doesn't have a GHL record), these workflows now simply **skip** the GHL step and carry on with everything else (texts, emails, Slack, logging). Nothing fails or gets stuck — it just means that one business won't get a GHL note until you connect their GHL account.

Testing checklist before going live

1. Book a test appointment through the phone system → confirm the customer gets a "we've received your request" text (not "confirmed"), and staff get a Slack ping.
2. Trigger workflow 4 manually with test data → confirm the customer now gets the real "confirmed" text + email.
3. Ask the AI to cancel a test appointment close to its start time → confirm staff get an urgent Slack ping and the customer is told staff will follow up (not "cancelled").
4. Cancel a test appointment far in advance → confirm the customer gets a direct "cancelled" confirmation.
5. Simulate an emergency call → confirm the on-call phone/email/Slack all fire.
6. Ask for "a real person" → confirm the handoff email/Slack/GHL task fire.
7. Upload a test knowledge document → confirm it appears in Pinecone and the `#kb-updates` Slack message posts; then try breaking it (bad file) to confirm `#automation-alerts` fires instead of the workflow silently failing.
8. Let a test call go to voicemail → confirm the callback text and GHL task fire.